SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

14 September 2023 · Shift 3

45 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 45 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

General Awareness 20 questions

Q.1

Which of the following Indian playback singers received the Bharat Ratna in 2001?

(A) KS Chithra
(B) Geeta Dutt
(C) Lata Mangeshkar
(D) Asha Bhosle

Q.2

Which of the following cricket players wrote the autobiography ‘Playing It My Way’?

(A) Yuvraj Singh
(B) Sourav Ganguly
(C) Sachin Tendulkar
(D) Kiran More

Q.3

In which city is the India Gate situated?

(A) Delhi
(B) Ahmedabad
(C) Lucknow
(D) Mumbai

Q.4

Who authored the book ‘Poverty and Un-British Rule in India’ in 1901, which was highly critical of the economic impact of British Rule?

(A) Pherozeshah Mehta
(B) Dadabhai Naoroji
(C) WC Bonnerji
(D) Badruddin Tyabji

Q.5

The efforts of Malayalam poet Vallathol Narayana Menon and dancer and guru Kalyanikutty Amma brought back and gave a new life to the dance form _____.

(A) Bharatanatyam
(B) Kuchipudi
(C) Mohiniyattam
(D) Kathakali

Q.6

Where was All Indian Muslim League formed in 1906?

(A) Agra
(B) Dhaka
(C) Lahore
(D) Delhi

Q.7

Which of the following writers wrote the autobiography ‘Truth, Love and a Little Malice’?

(A) Khushwant Singh
(B) Chetan Bhagat
(C) Pratibha Ray
(D) Amrita Pritam

Q.8

In 2023, a three-day All-India Taekwondo Championship was organized in _____ to mark 50 years of Korea-India diplomatic relations.

(A) Kolkata
(B) Bengaluru
(C) Mizoram
(D) New Delhi

Q.9

The outward remittances under the Reserve Bank of India's _____ made a strong comeback in the first quarter of FY23 as Indians increased spending on international travel, maintenance of close relatives and gifts.

(A) Liberalised Remittance Scheme
(B) Regular Remittance Scheme
(C) Liquid Remittances Scheme
(D) Foreign Remittances Scheme

Q.10

The Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana (PMMY) scheme provide loans up to _____ to the non-corporate, non-farm small and micro entrepreneurs. (As of April 2023).

(A) 5 lakh
(B) 10 lakh
(C) 2.5 lakh
(D) 1 lakh

Q.12

The _____ maestros who revived the art form in the late 1940s include Kelucharan Mohapatra and Raghunath Dutta.

(A) Sattriya
(B) Odissi
(C) Manipuri
(D) Chhau

Q.14

Which of the following is true about disposable income in relation to personal income?

(A) Disposable income is equal to personal income.
(B) Disposable income is always less than personal income.
(C) Disposable income is always greater than personal income.
(D) Disposable income can be greater or less than personal income, depending on taxes and deductions.

Q.15

Which of the following best describes the process of calorimetry?

(A) Measuring the amount of compressive strength
(B) Measuring the amount of force
(C) Measuring the amount of electricity
(D) Measuring the amount of heat energy transferred

Q.16

Which Article of the Constitution of India provides early childhood care and education for all children until they complete the age of six years?

(A) Article 38
(B) Article 39
(C) Article 45
(D) Article 40

Q.17

Which of the following is NOT a constitutional body?

(A) Election Commission
(B) Finance Commission
(C) Union Public Service Commission
(D) NITI Aayog

Q.19

According to the National Multidimensional Poverty Index of NITI Aayog 2021, which of the following states has less than 1% multidimensionally Poor of its total population?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Punjab
(C) Telangana
(D) Kerala

Q.20

According to the Hindu calendar, Holi is celebrated on _____.

(A) Chaitra Purnima
(B) Pausa Purnima
(C) Phalguna Purnima
(D) Magha Purnima

Q.23

Which Indian sprinter bagged two gold medals, one each in the men's 100 and 200-metre races at the Flanders Cup 2023 athletics meet?

(A) Mohammed Afsal P
(B) Amlan Borgohain
(C) Tejas Shirse
(D) Jinson Johnson

Q.24

Who became the first Indian javelin ace to win the gold at the Zurich Diamond League?

(A) Sahil Silwal
(B) Shivpal Yadav
(C) Neeraj Chopra
(D) Rohit Yadav

Q.25

Which curve examines the relationship between the rate of unemployment and the rate of money wage changes?

(A) Phillips curve
(B) Indifference curve
(C) Supply curve
(D) Demand curve

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. When I was in high school / I participated in several extracurricular activities / such as the debate team and the school newspaper / which help me developed my communication and writing skills.

(A) When I was in high school
(B) which help me developed my communication and writing skills
(C) such as the debate team and the school newspaper
(D) I participated in several extracurricular activities

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The rise in temperature is playing havoc with India's "rainfall which is pertinent" for India's agriculture sector.

(A) rainfall who is pertinent
(B) rainfall which is significant
(C) rainfall which is decant
(D) rainfall which was mendicant

Q.3

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. Sameera has been in _____ since she got selected for a highly paid job at a multinational company.

(A) seventh heaven
(B) all the rage
(C) the dark
(D) a cold day in July

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined segment in the given sentence. I hope you “break a leg” at your performance tonight!

(A) Give up
(B) Make a mistake
(C) Perform well
(D) Hurt yourself

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Winning the championship was a dream come true for the team, but being awarded the MVP trophy was _____.

(A) the silver lining
(B) the bird in the bush
(C) a cold turkey
(D) the icing on the cake

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. We requested grandmother to “extend” her visit.

(A) Imperil
(B) Curtail
(C) Assail
(D) Bewail

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Simon “is afraid of closed space.”

(A) has xenophobia
(B) has ecophobia
(C) has claustrophobia
(D) has hydrophobia

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Magnificent

(A) Justify
(B) Glorious
(C) Highest
(D) Modest

Q.9

The sentence given below contains some spelling errors. Select the option that has the correct spellings. Appliications of subjects like Physiks and chemmistry in our dayly life also have higher visibelity than those of Biology.

(A) Applicasions of subjects like Physiks and Cemistry in our dayly life also have higher visibility than those of Biology.
(B) Appliications of subjects like Physics and chemistry in our dayly life also have higher visibelity than those of Biology.
(C) Applications of subjects like Physics and Chemistry in our daily life also have higher visibility than those of Biology.
(D) Applicacions of subjects like Physics and chemmistry in our daily life also have higher visibilety than those of Biology.

Q.10

Parts of the given sentence have been underlined. One of them contains an error. The underlined parts are given as options with some changes. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. The weather “is” “cold” tonight than “it” “was” yesterday.

(A) its
(B) are
(C) were
(D) colder

Q.11

Select the option that correctly rectifies the underlined spelling error in the given sentence. Little children are afraid to go to school because of the “agrassive” seniors who tend to bully them.

(A) Aggresive
(B) Aggressive
(C) Agrresive
(D) Agrressive

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The scratches on her hands were clear signs of domestic violence, _____ and said that she got scratched by barbed wire fencing.

(A) and poverty
(B) yet she lied
(C) which was enough evidence
(D) done a while ago

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Rahul’s sister says that “my brother is the best dancer in the city”.

(A) her brother is the best dancer in the city
(B) my brother was the best dancer in the city
(C) her brother was the best dancer in the city
(D) his brother was the best dancer in the city

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No improvement required’. A wonder in the plant kingdom, the Great Banyan Tree of the AJC Bose Botanical Garden at Shibpur in Howrah, “occupies a unique position in” the world records.

(A) occupying a unique position in
(B) occupies an unique position in
(C) No improvement required
(D) being occupied a unique position of

Q.15

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. The cholera is a frightful disease.

(A) is
(B) The cholera
(C) frightful disease
(D) a

Q.16

The sentence given below has spelling errors. Select the sentence without spelling errors. Knowledge and awareness about my own self has to preceede my knowledge of things other than me.

(A) Knowledge and awareness about my own self has to preceede my knowledge of things other then me.
(B) Knowledge and awareness about my own self has to precede my knowledge of things other than me.
(C) Knowlegde and awareness about my own self has to preceede my knowlegde of things other than me.
(D) Knowledge and awarenes about my own self has to preceede my knowledge of things other than me.

Q.17

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. If Peter said he would get that book for you, he will do it. He always _____.

(A) keeps under his hat
(B) keeps him at arm’s length
(C) keeps his word
(D) keeps his shirt on

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. It “has raining” very hard and he has a very large umbrella to keep off the rain-drops.

(A) shall rain
(B) is raining
(C) will be rainy
(D) rained

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. Shiya had more “grit” than her other siblings.

(A) power
(B) level
(C) gap
(D) courage

Q.20

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) The twins are / (B) often told that / (C) they are resembling / (D) each other.

(A) C
(B) A
(C) B
(D) D

Q.21

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Each essay is set (1)_____ against its background and made simpler by providing (2)_____ summary and critical commentary, short notes on textual issues, and (3)_____ of important critical and theoretical issues under the heading essay topics. (4)_____ of the most commonly used terms in the literature is given at the end and meant to serve as ready reference. This book will cater the (5)_____ of students of literature and teachers teaching this course.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) in
(B) at
(C) on
(D) off

Q.22

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Each essay is set (1)_____ against its background and made simpler by providing (2)_____ summary and critical commentary, short notes on textual issues, and (3)_____ of important critical and theoretical issues under the heading essay topics. (4)_____ of the most commonly used terms in the literature is given at the end and meant to serve as ready reference. This book will cater the (5)_____ of students of literature and teachers teaching this course.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) there
(B) its
(C) that
(D) this

Q.23

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Each essay is set (1)_____ against its background and made simpler by providing (2)_____ summary and critical commentary, short notes on textual issues, and (3)_____ of important critical and theoretical issues under the heading essay topics. (4)_____ of the most commonly used terms in the literature is given at the end and meant to serve as ready reference. This book will cater the (5)_____ of students of literature and teachers teaching this course.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) mindset
(B) chats
(C) discussions
(D) thinking

Q.24

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Each essay is set (1)_____ against its background and made simpler by providing (2)_____ summary and critical commentary, short notes on textual issues, and (3)_____ of important critical and theoretical issues under the heading essay topics. (4)_____ of the most commonly used terms in the literature is given at the end and meant to serve as ready reference. This book will cater the (5)_____ of students of literature and teachers teaching this course.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) figures
(B) glossary
(C) grammar
(D) data

Q.25

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Each essay is set (1)_____ against its background and made simpler by providing (2)_____ summary and critical commentary, short notes on textual issues, and (3)_____ of important critical and theoretical issues under the heading essay topics. (4)_____ of the most commonly used terms in the literature is given at the end and meant to serve as ready reference. This book will cater the (5)_____ of students of literature and teachers teaching this course.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) desires
(B) whims
(C) feelings
(D) needs

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**
Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**
Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**				

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Lata Mangeshkar

Lata Mangeshkar received the Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian award, in 2001, the same year as the shehnai maestro Bismillah Khan.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Sachin Tendulkar

'Playing It My Way' (2014), written with Boria Majumdar, is Sachin Tendulkar's autobiography.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Delhi

India Gate in New Delhi, designed by Edwin Lutyens, was built as the All India War Memorial to the soldiers of the British Indian Army who died in the First World War.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Dadabhai Naoroji

Dadabhai Naoroji's 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India' (1901) set out his drain theory: that British rule was draining India's wealth to Britain.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Mohiniyattam

Mohiniyattam, Kerala's classical dance for women, had almost died out when Vallathol, who founded the Kerala Kalamandalam in 1930, brought it into its teaching; Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma, one of its students, spent her life reviving it and is called the mother of Mohiniyattam.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Dhaka

The All India Muslim League was founded at Dhaka on 30 December 1906, at a meeting held during the session of the All India Muhammadan Educational Conference there.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Khushwant Singh

'Truth, Love and a Little Malice' (2002) is the autobiography of the writer and journalist Khushwant Singh.

Q.8 · Answer (D) New Delhi

The championship, held by the Sports Authority of India with the Korean Cultural Centre India, was played at the Indira Gandhi Stadium in New Delhi in February 2023, the 50th year of India-Korea diplomatic relations.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Liberalised Remittance Scheme

Under the RBI's Liberalised Remittance Scheme (2004), resident individuals could send up to US$250,000 abroad in a financial year when the exam was held (September 2023), for permitted purposes such as travel, study, gifts and the maintenance of relatives.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 10 lakh

When the exam was held (September 2023), MUDRA loans came in three categories: Shishu up to ₹50,000, Kishore up to ₹5 lakh and Tarun up to ₹10 lakh, so the ceiling was ₹10 lakh. A Tarun Plus category, up to ₹20 lakh, was added in October 2024.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Odissi

Kelucharan Mohapatra and Raghunath Dutta, with gurus such as Pankaj Charan Das, Deba Prasad Das and Mayadhar Raut, rebuilt Odissi, Odisha's classical dance, from the temple dance of the maharis and the gotipua tradition.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Disposable income is always less than personal income.

SSC's key gives 'always less': personal disposable income is personal income minus the direct taxes and the fees and fines that households pay to the government. An economy always makes such payments, so its disposable income is less than its personal income and can never be greater.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Measuring the amount of heat energy transferred

Calorimetry measures the heat given out or taken in during a physical or chemical change, usually from the change in temperature of a known mass of water in a calorimeter.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Article 45
Article 45, as substituted by the 86th Amendment (2002), directs the State to provide early childhood care and education for all children until they complete the age of six; the same amendment made education from 6 to 14 a fundamental right (Article 21A).

Q.17 · Answer (D) NITI Aayog
NITI Aayog was set up on 1 January 2015 by a Union Cabinet resolution, in place of the Planning Commission, so it is neither constitutional nor statutory. The Election Commission (Article 324), the Finance Commission (Article 280) and the UPSC (Article 315) are constitutional bodies.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Kerala
In NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index (baseline report, 2021) Kerala had the lowest share of multidimensionally poor people, 0.71%; Punjab, Telangana and Maharashtra were well above 1%.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Phalguna Purnima
Holi falls on the full moon (purnima) of the month of Phalguna, usually in March: Holika Dahan is lit that night and colours are played the next day.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Amlan Borgohain
Amlan Borgohain won both the 100 m and the 200 m at the Flanders Cup 2023, the International Antwerp Athletics Gala at Merksem, Belgium, in June 2023.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Neeraj Chopra
Neeraj Chopra won the Diamond League final in Zurich in September 2022 with a throw of 88.44 m, the first Indian to win a Diamond League title.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Phillips curve
The Phillips curve, from A. W. Phillips's 1958 study of British data, shows an inverse relation between the rate of unemployment and the rate of change of money wages.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) which help me developed my communication and writing skills
After 'help me' the verb takes its base form, and the activities belong to the past: 'which helped me develop my communication and writing skills'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) rainfall which is significant
'Pertinent' means relevant to the matter at hand; rainfall that matters a great deal to farming is 'significant' for it. 'Who' is used for people, and 'decant' and 'mendicant' make no sense here.

Q.3 · Answer (A) seventh heaven
To be in 'seventh heaven' is to be extremely happy, as Sameera is after landing a well-paid job.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Perform well
'Break a leg' is said to wish a performer good luck: it means 'perform well'.

Q.5 · Answer (D) the icing on the cake
'The icing on the cake' is something good added to what is already good, here the trophy on top of the championship. A 'silver lining' is the hopeful side of a bad situation.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Curtail
To 'extend' a visit is to lengthen it; to 'curtail' it is to cut it short.

Q.7 · Answer (C) has claustrophobia
'Claustrophobia' is the fear of closed or confined spaces; xenophobia is a fear or dislike of foreigners and hydrophobia a fear of water.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Glorious
'Magnificent' means splendid or impressive: 'glorious'. 'Modest' is nearly its opposite.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Applications of subjects like Physics and Chemistry in our daily life also have higher visibility than those of Biology.
The correct spellings are 'applications', 'physics', 'chemistry', 'daily' and 'visibility'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) colder
'Than' needs the comparative: 'The weather is colder tonight than it was yesterday.'

Q.11 · Answer (B) Aggressive
The correct spelling is 'aggressive', with a double 'g' and a double 's'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) yet she lied
The second half contrasts with the first: the scratches pointed to violence, 'yet she lied' and blamed the fencing, with 'she' as the subject of both 'lied' and 'said'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) her brother is the best dancer in the city
Reporting the sister's words, her 'my brother' becomes 'her brother'; with the reporting verb 'says' in the present tense, 'is' does not change: 'Rahul's sister says that her brother is the best dancer in the city.'

Q.14 · Answer (C) No improvement required
No improvement: the singular subject 'the Great Banyan Tree' takes 'occupies', 'a unique' is right because 'unique' begins with a consonant sound, and a place is held 'in' the records.

Q.15 · Answer (B) The cholera
The names of most diseases take no article: 'Cholera is a frightful disease.'

Q.16 · Answer (B) Knowledge and awareness about my own self has to precede my knowledge of things other than me.
The correct spelling is 'precede', to come before; the other sentences keep 'preceede' and also misspell 'than', 'knowledge' or 'awareness'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) keeps his word
To 'keep one's word' is to do what one has promised.

Q.18 · Answer (B) is raining
'Has' is not followed directly by an '-ing' form; the present continuous 'is raining' matches the present 'has' in the second clause.

Q.19 · Answer (D) courage
'Grit' is courage and determination in the face of difficulty: 'courage'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) C
'Resemble' is a stative verb and is not used in the continuous: 'they resemble each other'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) off
To 'set off' something against a background is to place it where it shows up clearly: each essay is presented against its background.

Q.22 · Answer (B) its
The possessive 'its' refers back to the essay: the book provides its summary and critical commentary.

Q.23 · Answer (C) discussions
A study guide offers 'discussions of' important critical and theoretical issues; 'chats' is too casual, and 'mindset' and 'thinking' do not fit a section of a book.

Q.24 · Answer (B) glossary
A list of the commonly used terms of a subject, given with their meanings at the end of a book, is a 'glossary'.

Q.25 · Answer (D) needs
A book caters to the 'needs' of its readers, what a course requires of them; 'whims' and 'desires' are passing wishes, and 'feelings' do not fit.

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